

List of Kanji

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漢字 1: Near (近)

近	近	
Near. The sense of <i>recent</i> is also incorporated.		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	斤 + 辵
English	Axe + Walk/Road

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Nearly	got [axed] while [walking] on the [road].

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	キン (KIN)	ちか (chika)
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Near <KINDRED> to us are the <chickadees>.

‡Chickadees are a group of North American birds in the tit family.

+ Words and Compounds		
Example	English	Pronunciation
近い	<i>near</i>	ちかい (chikai)
近づく	<i>to approach</i>	ちかづく (chikazuku)
近道	near + road = <i>shortcut</i>	ちかみち (chika-michi)
近親	near + parent = <i>close relative</i>	キンシン (KINSHIN)
最近	most + near = <i>recently</i>	サイキン (SAIKIN)

{...} Sample Sentence							
新しい	家	は	川	の	近く	に	あります。
あたら しい	いえ	は	かわ	の	ちかく	に	あり ます
new	house	は	river	の	near	に	is
The new house is near a river.							

漢字 2: Lose (失)

失	失	
Lose, in the sense of <i>mislay</i> . This character often conveys a hint of <i>failure and error</i> .		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	大 + 亾
English	Large + Person

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Losing	[people] is a [big] loss.

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	シツ (SHITSU)	うしな (ushina)
L.C.	—	—

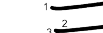
♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Lose your <SHEETS> until <you shine>.

+ Words and Compounds		
Example	English	Pronunciation
失う	<i>to lose</i>	うしなう (ushina-u)
見失う	see + lose = <i>to lose sight of</i>	み うしなう (mi ushinau)
失言	lose + say = <i>slip of the tongue</i>	シスゲン (SHITSU-GEN)

{...} Sample Sentence			
大会	で	失言	しました。
タイカイ	で	シツゲン	しました
convention	で	slip of the tongue	did
(I) made a slip of the tongue at the convention.			

漢字 3: Bow (弓)

		
Bow (the partner to an arrow).		

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	𐄂
English	Bow

⦿ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Part of the 漢字 radicals (#57).

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	キュウ (KYŪ)	ゆみ (yumi)
L.C.	—	—

♣♫ Meaning ⇔ Pronunciations

This bow will **⟨KILL YOU⟩** $\prec$ yummily $\succ$.

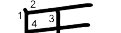
+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
弓	<i>bow</i>	ゆみ (yumi)
弓道	bow + road = (<i>Japanese</i>) <i>archery</i>	キウウ・ドウ (KYŪ・DŌ)

$\{\dots\}$ Sample Sentence

これ	は	強い	人	が	使う	弓	です。
これ	は	つよい	ひと	が	つかう	ゆみ	です
this	は	strong person	が	to use	bow	be / is	
<i>This is a bow for a strong person.</i>							

漢字 4: Horse (馬)

馬	 Diagram showing the stroke order for writing the character 馬 (Uchiwa). The strokes are numbered 1 through 10.	
Horse.		

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	馬
English	Horse

$\clubsuit \in \text{Meaning} \leftrightarrow \text{Glyph Components}$
Part of the 漢字 radicals (#187).

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	バ (BA)	うま (uma)
L.C.	—	—

♣🎵 Meaning ⇔ Pronunciations

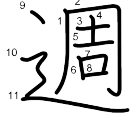
Horse -⟨BUM⟩ is $\prec \mathbf{umami} \succ$.
[‡] <i>Umami</i> means “essence of deliciousness” in Japanese.

+ Words and Compounds

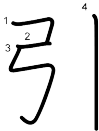
Example	English	Pronunciation
馬	<i>horse</i>	うま (uma)
子馬	child + horse = <i>colt</i> ; <i>pony</i>	こ・うま (ko·uma)
牛馬	cow + horse = <i>cows</i> <i>and horses</i>	ギユウ・バ (GYŪ·BA)
馬具	horse + tool = <i>harness</i>	バ・グ (BA·GU)

$\{\dots\}$ Sample Sentence

馬	と	牛	の	どちら	が	好き	です	か。
うま	と	うし	の	どちら	が	すき	です	か
horse	と	cow	の	which	が	like	be / is	か
<i>Which do you like, horses or cows?</i>								

漢字 5: Week (週)		
		
Week.		
	∈ Composition	
Glyphs	周 + 辵	
English	Around (??) + Walk/Road	
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components		
Weeks	of 「walking」 「around」.	
	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	シュウ (SHŪ)	—
L.C.	—	—
♣♣ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations		
Weekly	〈SHOES〉.	

+ Words and Compounds		
Example	English	Pronunciation
週間	week + interval = <i>week</i>	シュウ・カン (SHŪ-KAN)
一週間	one + week + interval = <i>one week</i>	イッ・シュウ・カン (ISSHŪ-KAN)
二週間	two + week + interval = <i>two weeks</i>	ニ・シュウ・カン (NISHŪ-KAN)
週日	week + sun (day) = <i>weekday</i>	シュウ・ジツ (SHŪ-JITSU)
先週	precede + week = <i>last week</i>	セン・シュウ (SENSHŪ)
来週	come + week = <i>next week</i>	ライ・シュウ (RAISHŪ)
{...} Sample Sentence		
来週	また	会いたい。
ライシュウ	また	あいたい
next week	again	to meet
<i>I'd like to see you again next week.</i>		

漢字 6: Pull (引)		
		
Pull.		
This character also conveys the idea of <i>attraction</i> (best seen in the fourth example), and the sense of <i>receding</i> and <i>withdrawing</i> .		
You will notice it frequently on signs; it indicates <i>pull</i> on doors, and <i>discount</i> when used with numbers.		
	∈ Composition	
Glyphs	弓 + 丨	
English	Bow + Line/Pole/Vertical stroke	
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components		
Pull	the [bow] in a straight [line].	
	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	イン (IN)	ひ (hi)
L.C.	—	—
♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations		
Pull	<heaps> of (INK).	

+ Words and Compounds		
Example	English	Pronunciation
As seen in the third example, this is another 漢字 that can act like 買. The 訓読み can also become voiced in the second position, as happens in the fifth compound.		
引く	<i>to pull</i>	ひく (hiku)
引き出す	pull + exit = <i>to withdraw (something)</i>	ひき だす (hiki dasu)
引出し	pull + exit = <i>a withdrawal; a drawer</i>	ひき だし (hiki dashi)
引力	pull + strength = <i>gravitation</i>	イン・リョク (IN-RYOKU)
万引き	ten thousand + pull = <i>shoplifter</i>	マン びき (MAN biki)
引き受ける	pull + receive = <i>to undertake</i>	ひき うける (hiki ukeru)
引き上げる	pull + upper = <i>to pull up</i>	ひき あげる (hiki ageru)
{...} Sample Sentence		
引力	が	惑星 を 引き付ける。
インリョク	が	ワクセイ を ひきつける
gravitation	が	planets を to attract
<i>Gravity binds the planets to the sun.</i>		

漢字 7: Second (秒)

		
Second (of time or arc).		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	禾 + 少
English	Two-branch tree/Grain + Few (??)

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Seconds	until a [few] [crops] remained.

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ビョウ (BYŌ)	—
L.C.	—	—

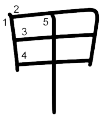
♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Seconds	untill it will <BE YOURS>.
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+ Words and Compounds		
Example	English	Pronunciation
一秒	one + second = <i>one second</i>	イチ・ビョウ (ICHI-BYŌ)
五秒	five + second = <i>five seconds</i>	ゴ・ビョウ (GO-BYŌ)
秒読み	second + read = <i>countdown</i>	ビョウ よみ (BYŌ yomi)

{...} Sample Sentence		
十五分	二十秒	掛かりました。
ジュウゴフン	ニジュウビョウ	かかりました
15 minutes	20 seconds	took
<i>It took fifteen minutes and twenty seconds.</i>		

漢字 8: Shell (甲)

		
Shell. This character rarely appears on its own, but proves valuable as a component.		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	田
English	Rice field

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Shells	in the [rice field].

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	コウ (KŌ)	—
L.C.	カン (KAN)	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Shells	<CAUSE> <CUNNING> schemes.
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+ Words and Compounds		
Example	English	Pronunciation
手の甲	hand + shell = <i>back of the hand</i>	ての・コウ (teno-KŌ)

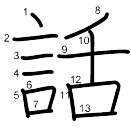
{...} Sample Sentence				
上田さん	は	手の甲	が	かゆい。
うえださん	は	ての・コウ	が	かゆい
Ueda-san	は	back of hand	が	itchy
<i>The back of Ueda's hand is itchy.</i>				

気持ち	が	悪く	なった。
キもち	が	わるく	なった
feeling	が	bad	to attain
<i>A strange feeling came over me.</i>			

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
時計	time + measure = <i>watch; clock</i>	と・ケイ (to·KEI)

八時半	に	東口	の	近く	で	会いましょう。
ハチジハン	に	ひがしぐち	の	ちかく	で	あいましょう
Eight-thirty	に	east entrance	の	near	で	let's meet
Let's meet near the east entrance at eight-thirty.						

漢字 11: Speak (話)

話		
Speak, along with the ideas of <i>conversations</i> and <i>stories</i> .		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	言 + 舌
English	Say/Speaking/Speech + Tongue

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
“Speak”, [says] the [tongue].

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ワ (WA)	はなし、はな (hanashi, hana)
As in the final example below, the 訓読み for this 漢字 is always voiced in the second position.		
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Speak of how <hung-up> <Hanah shielded> us from being (WASHED).

+ Words and Compounds		
Example	English	Pronunciation
話	<i>story</i>	はなし (hanashi)
話す	<i>to speak</i>	はなす (hanasu)
話し好き	speak + like = <i>talkative</i>	はなし ずき (hanashi zuki)
電話	electric + speak = <i>telephone</i>	デン・ワ (DEN-WA)
会話	meet + speak = <i>conversation</i>	カイ・ワ (KAI-WA)
立ち話	stand + speak = <i>chatting while standing</i>	たち ばなし (tachi banashi)

{...} Sample Sentence				
君	に	電話	です。	
きみ	に	デンワ	です	
you	に	telephone	be / is	
<i>You are wanted on the phone.</i>				

漢字 12: English (英)

英		
English. A secondary meaning relates to <i>brilliance</i> .		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	艸 + 央
English	Grass + Center (??)

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Brilliant English [grass] is in the [centre].

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	エイ (EI)	—
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

English <AIM> for world domination.

+ Words and Compounds		
Example	English	Pronunciation
英語	English + words = <i>English language</i>	エイ・ゴ (EIGO)
英国	English + country = <i>England</i>	エイ・コク (EIKOKU)
英会話	English + meet + speak = <i>English conversation</i>	エイ・カイ・ワ (EIKAIWA)
日英	sun + English = <i>Japan and England</i>	ニチ・エイ (NICHIEI)

{...} Sample Sentence				
私	は	英語	が	読める。
わたし	は	エイゴ	が	よめる
I	は	English	が	to read
<i>I am able to read English.</i>				

漢字 13: Instruction (訓)

訓	訓	
Instruction.		
This 漢字 tends to give a more serious or spiritual sense of <i>teaching</i> to the compounds in which it appears.		

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	言 + 川
English	Say/Speaking/Speech + River

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Instruct the [river] to [say] something.

	♪ Pronunciations
	音読み 訓読み
Cm.	クン (KUN) —
L.C.	— —

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Instruct	the <RACCOON>?!
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+ Words and Compounds		
Example	English	Pronunciation
訓読み	instruction + read = <i>the kun-yomi</i>	クン よみ (KUN yomi)
訓話	instruction + speak = <i>moral discourse</i>	クン・ワ (KUN-WA)

{...} Sample Sentence		
これ	を 訓読み で 読んで 下さい。	
これ	を クンよみ で よんで ください	
this	を kun-yomi で read please	
<i>Please read this with kun-yomi.</i>		

漢字 14: Push (押)

押	押	
Push. Suppression. Restraint.		
This 漢字 also serves as the partner to 引 (Entry 6, page 5) on door signs.		

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	手 + 田
English	Hand + Rice field

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Push your [hand] into the [rice fields].

	♪ Pronunciations
	音読み 訓読み
Cm.	— お (o)
L.C.	オウ (OU) —

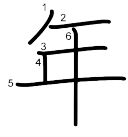
♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations
Pushing can be <AWEFULLY> <obligatory>.

+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
As indicated by the last two examples below, this is another 漢字 that often shows up in the manner of 買.		
押す	<i>to push</i>	おす (osu)
押し出す	push + exit = <i>to push out</i>	おし だす (oshi dasu)
押し上げる	push + upper = <i>to push up</i>	おし あげる (oshi ageru)
押し開ける	push + open = <i>to push open</i>	おし あける (oshi akeru)
押入れ	push + enter = <i>closet</i>	おし いれ (oshi ire)
押売	push + sell = <i>high-pressure sales</i>	おし・うり (oshi-uri)

{...} Sample Sentence		
押入れ	の 中 に 物 が 少ない。	
おしいれ	の なか に もの が すくない	
closet	の middle に things が few	
<i>There aren't many things in the closet.</i>		

漢字 15: Year (年)

年		
Year.		

∈ Composition		
Glyphs	𠂇 + 丰	
English	Person + WI (wheel...)	

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components		
Year	of [people] [wheeling] around in circles.	

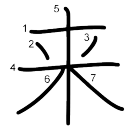
♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ネン (NEN)	とし (toshi)
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations		
The year the <NENETS> acquired <Toshiba>.		
‡ <i>Nenets</i> is an ethnic group native to Northern Arctic Russia. ‡ <i>Toshiba</i> is a semiconductor company and the inventor of flash memory. It is headquartered in Tōkyō.		

+ Words and Compounds		
Example	English	Pronunciation
年	<i>year</i>	とし (toshi)
年上	year + upper = <i>older</i>	としうえ (toshieue)
年下	year + lower = <i>younger</i>	としした (toshishita)
新年	new + year = <i>the New year</i>	シン・ネン (SHIN-NEN)
中年	middle + year = <i>middle age</i>	チュウ・ネン (CHŪ-NEN)
一年生	one + year + life = <i>first-year student</i>	イチ・ネン・セイ (ICHINENSEI)

{...} Sample Sentence			
青木さん	は	三年生	です。
あおきさん	は	サンネンセイ	です
Aoki-san	は	third year	be / is
<i>Aoki-san is a third-year student.</i>			

漢字 16: Come (来)

来		
Come.		
As the final four compounds below make clear, the related meanings of <i>next</i> is also included.		

∈ Composition		
Glyphs	一 + 米	
English	One + Rice	

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components		
Come	[one] [rice] grain at a time.	

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	アイ (RAI)	く (ku)
L.C.	—	き、こ (ki, ko)

This character is infamous for being one of the only two irregular verbs in Japanese. The character can be read variously as く, き, or こ, depending on which tense of the verb is being used. An important exception is found in the second compound below (also an extremely common word): when following 出, 来 is always read as き.

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations		
Come up with a <coup> to <keep> on <RHYMING> with <cobble>.		

+ Words and Compounds		
Example	English	Pronunciation
来る	<i>to come</i>	く・る (kuru)
出来る	exit + come = <i>to be able to</i>	で きる (de kiru)
来週	come + week = <i>next week</i>	ライ・シュウ (RAISHŪ)
来月	come + moon = <i>next month</i>	ライ・ゲツ (RAIGETSU)
来年	come + year = <i>next year</i>	ライ・ネン (RAINEN)
来春	come + spring = <i>next spring</i>	ライ・シュン (RAISHUN)

{...} Sample Sentence					
The sentence below is an example of the polite past tense.					
先生	は	一週間	前	に	来ました。
センセイ	は	イッシュ ウカン	まえ	に	きました。
teacher	は	1 week	before	に	came
The teacher came a week ago.					

漢字 17: Study (学)

		
Study. Learning.		
When used as a suffix, it is often equivalent to the English <i>-ology</i> . The final compound offers such an example.		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	子 + 小 [㇀] [㇁] [㇂] + 冫
English	Child + Small + Cover/Crown

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Study	the [small] hair [crowns] of [children].

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ガク (GAKU)	まな (mana)
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations	
Study	how to <manage> all this (GUCK).

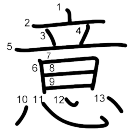
+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
学ぶ	<i>to study</i>	まなぶ (mana·bu)
大学	large + study = <i>university</i>	ダイ・ガク (DAI·GAKU)
学生	study + life = <i>student</i>	ガク・セイ (GAKU·SEI)
休学	rest + study = <i>absence from school</i>	キュウ・ガク (KYŪ·GAKU)
語学	words + study = <i>linguistics</i>	ゴ・ガク (GO·GAKU)
生物学	life + thing + study = <i>biology</i>	セイ・ブツ・ガク (SEI·BUTSU·GAKU)

{...} Sample Sentence

此の	家	に	は	大学生	が	多い。
この	いえ	に	は	ダイガク セイ	が	おおい。
this	house	に	は	university students	が	many
<i>There are many university students in this house.</i>						

漢字 18: Mind (意)

		
Mind. Thought.		
This abstract character appears in many compounds conveying the ideas of <i>will</i> , <i>intention</i> , and <i>opinion</i> , etc.		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	音 + 心
English	Sound + Heart

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Mind	[resonating] with [heart].

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	イ (I)	—
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Mind	the (INDICATORS).
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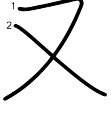
+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
意思	mind + think = <i>(one's) intent</i>	イ・シ (ISHI)
意図	mind + diagram = <i>(one's) aim</i>	イ・ト (ITO)
意外	mind + outside = <i>unforeseen</i>	イ・ガイ (IGAI)
*意見	mind + see = <i>opinion</i>	イ・ケン (IKEN)
意気	mind + spirit = <i>morale</i>	イ・キ (IKI)
注意	pour + mind = <i>attention</i>	チュウ・イ (CHŪ·I)

{...} Sample Sentence

あなた	の	意見	が	分かりません。
あなた	の	イケン	が	わかりません
you	の	opinion	が	don't understand
<i>I don't understand your opinion.</i>				

漢字 19: Again (又)

		
Again. Also.		
This 漢字 rarely appears on its own.		
The suggested visual mnemonic is an <i>ironing board</i> .		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	又
English	Again

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Part of the 漢字 radicals (#29).

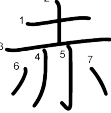
♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	—	また (mata)
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations
Again and again the <matador> irked the bull.
‡A <i>matador</i> is a bullfighter whose task is to kill the bull.

+ Words and Compounds		
Example	English	Pronunciation
Note how the second 漢字 in the final example below is voiced.		
又	<i>again</i>	また (mata)
又々	again + again = <i>once again</i>	またまた (matamata)
又聞き	again + hear = <i>hearsay</i>	またぎき (matagiki)

{...} Sample Sentence				
The pronunciation of 来なかった below is the informal past tense reading of 来.				
北川さん	は	又	来なかった	よ。
きたがわさん	は	また	こなかった	よ
Kitagawa-san	は	again	didn't come	よ
<i>Kitagawa-san didn't come again!</i>				

漢字 20: Red (赤)

		
Red.		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	赤
English	Red

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Part of the 漢字 radicals (#155).

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	セキ (SEKI)	あか (aka)
L.C.	シャク (SHAKU)	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations
Red is <also known as> <SEXY>. <SHUCKS>!

+ Words and Compounds		
Example	English	Pronunciation
赤	<i>red (noun)</i>	あか (aka)
赤い	<i>red (adjective)</i>	あかい (akai)
赤ちゃん	<i>baby</i>	あかちゃん (akachan)
赤道	red + road = <i>equator</i>	セキドウ (SEKIDŌ)

{...} Sample Sentence			
木の葉	が	赤く	なった。
きのは	が	あかく	なった
foliage	が	red	to become
<i>The leaves of the trees have turned red.</i>			

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漢字 by Stroke Count

2 Strokes		5 Strokes		赤	12	10 Strokes	
又	12	失	3	8 Strokes		時	7
3 Strokes		甲	6	学	11	訓	9
弓	4	6 Strokes		押	9	馬	4
4 Strokes		年	10	英	8	11 Strokes	
引	5	氣	7	9 Strokes		週	5
近	3	7 Strokes		秒	6	13 Strokes	
		来	10			意	11
						話	8